ACCEPTABLE USE POLICY CONTRACT FOR STUDENTS/PARENTS

Ocean Springs School District

PLEASE READ THIS DOCUMENT CAREFULLY BEFORE COMPLETING AND SIGNING THE CONTRACT ON THE OPPOSITE SIDE. NO STUDENT WILL BE GIVEN INTERNET ACCESS UNLESS THE PARENT/ GUARDIAN READS THIS POLICY AND SIGNS THE CONTRACT THAT ANNOUNCES THE POSSIBLE RISKS OF USING THE INTERNET.

THE SCHOOL DISTRICT TAKES EVERY REASONABLE PRECAUTION TO ENSURE THE INTERNET IS SAFE. INTERNET FILTERS AND AGE APPROPRIATE TRAINING ABOUT INTERNET SAFETY AND ONLINE BEHAVIOR ARE PROVIDED. HOWEVER, STUDENTS MAY ATTEMPT TO BYPASS THE SCHOOL FILTERS OR USE HOME COMPUTERS THAT EXPOSE YOUR STUDENT TO THE FOLLOWING RISKS:

- Sharing offensive websites with other students
- Sending and receiving inappropriate e-mail, blogs and other prohibited messages
- Sharing offensive material created at home
- Sending or receiving libelous electronic messages
- Engaging in the violation of criminal and civil laws
- Engaging in cyberbullying
- Illegally uploading or downloading copyrighted material
- Using your child's picture in a false light
- Violating your child's privacy regarding health and other personal issues

The Ocean Springs School District School Board of Education provides Internet access to students for educational purposes only. The use of the Internet is necessary for many school research projects. Misuse of the Internet violates school board policy and subjects your child to suspensions and other school disciplinary consequences. Additionally, your child may incur civil and criminal penalties under Mississippi and Federal law for misuse of the Internet. Some of the misuses are as follows:

- Using proxy sites(sites that allow the user to bypass the district Internet filter) to avoid the district filter
- Sending and distributing offensive material on district computers or school grounds
- Sending cyber-threats of death, bodily harm, damage to property to other students or staff
- Creating offensive materials on home computers and distributing them on school grounds
- Using their own portable devices to distribute offensive material on school grounds

General guidelines include but are not limited to the following:

- The student should have no expectation of privacy at any time while using district resources, nor at home when it pertains to school business
- The district is authorized to monitor e-mail logs and Internet histories of students and does so.
- Students should use the Internet/network for appropriate educational purposes and research.
- Students should use the Internet/network only with the permission of designated school staff.
- Students should be considerate of other users on the network.
- Students must use appropriate language for school situations and must not use vulgar or profane language or images, including those with implied vulgarity and/or profanity.
- Students should immediately report any security problems or breeches of these responsibilities to the supervising teacher.
- Students must adhere to copyright laws and plagiarism rules when using the Internet.
- Students must not share user IDs and passwords required to access e-mail and other programs.
- Students must not give out personal information about themselves or where they live.
- Students must not fill out forms on the Internet without parent/teacher permission.
- Students must not send pictures of themselves through e-mail.
- Students may not have access to e-commerce or publicly provided Internet Service Providers.
- Students will receive district accounts upon teacher request and parent permission if the accounts are needed for educational projects.
- Students must not use proxy avoidance sites (sites that allow the user to bypass the district Internet filter) or other sites indicated as blocked. Use of these sites violates this contract and could result in loss of Internet access and/or other disciplinary actions.
- Students must not intentionally degrade or disrupt Internet network services or equipment. This includes but is not limited to tampering with computer hardware or software, vandalizing data, invoking computer viruses, attempting to gain access to restricted or unauthorized network services, unauthorized redirection of school web pages or violating copyright laws.
- Students must not work directly on teacher, school, or district department webs without express written permission from the district Web Administrator and/or Director of Technology.
- Students must not construct websites using content or links that violate state or federal laws.
- Students must not use the network in a fashion inconsistent with directions from teachers and other staff.

Based on reading this Internet Acceptable Use Policy, I have determined that the benefits of my child having access to the Internet outweigh the risks. I also agree that I will properly supervise my child's computer activity at home and will advise the Ocean Springs School District immediately if I discover that my child is violating this user agreement at home or at school. Additionally, I agree to notify the Ocean Springs School District immediately if I discover my child or my child's fellow students are committing civil and criminal violations of the law. Failure to report this behavior is negligent supervision and relieves the school of any liability that flows from this behavior if the school could not have reasonably foreseen this type of behavior on your child's home computer. I understand that any conduct by my child that is in conflict with these responsibilities is inappropriate and that such behavior may result in the termination of access and possible disciplinary action. By completing and signing this contract (on opposite side) I also agree to compensate the Ocean Springs School District for any expenses or cost it incurs as a result of my child's violation of the Internet policy or administrative procedure.

RELEVANT SCHOOL LAWS

Violating this contract could result in loss of Internet access and/or other disciplinary actions.
See School Board Policy
http://oceansprings.msbapolicy.org/DistrictPolicies/Views/SelectedDocumentReadOnly/tabid/282/Default.aspx?docId=23033

RELEVANT STATE STATUTES

Title 97, Chapter 45, Mississippi Code of 1972, so as to refer to "Computer Crimes and Identity Theft."

PUBLIC LAW 106-554

TITLE XVII--CHILDREN'S INTERNET PROTECTION (http://www.fcc.gov/cgb/consumerfacts/cipa.html)

TITLE XIII-CHILDREN'S ONLINE PRIVACY PROTECTION (http://www.coppa.org/coppa.htm)

This contract is a legal and binding document

Internet Usage-Online Agreement

As parent/guardian of this student, I understand the risks associated with allowing my child to use the Internet. Furthermore, in signing this policy electronically through the OSSD Parent Portal, I affirm that the school district made a reasonable attempt to educate me on the known potential risks of using the Internet and the school's rules and goals of Internet use. Based on this adequate notice, I agree not to hold the Ocean Springs School District responsible for materials acquired or contacts made on the network.

I have read these responsibilities and agree that I will review them with my child, so that he or she clearly understands this acceptable use policy and agrees to obey all school procedures, civil, and criminal laws.

The choices are explained further below.

***I hereby grant _____** ****Only during class activities, I hereby grant_____** *****I hereby do not grant_____** permission to the Ocean Springs School District **to provide network and Internet access at school**.

*****Please be advised that if you select this option your student will not be permitted to use the district Internet access in drop-in labs or the media center unless accommodated and supervised by the classroom teacher during classroom activities.***

******Please be advised that if you select this option your student will not be permitted to use the district Internet access for research and exploration, but your child will still be instructed through the use of Internet-based educational software deemed vital to your child's educational success.***

Media Agreement-Online Agreement

For a variety of reasons (academic activities, athletics, clubs, etc.) your child's name, individual student picture/video image, and/or creative work(s), may appear on a school- or district-related *website, **newsletter or community newspaper. Also, some activities may involve a classroom to classroom *video exchange, for example, students studying volcanoes could use video equipment (e.g., webcam) to see and talk to students in a classroom near Mount St. Helens.

The choices are explained further below.

***I hereby grant _____** **I hereby do not grant_____**
permission to the Ocean Springs School District to place my child's name, individual student picture/video/webcam image, and/or creative work(s**) on a school- or district-related website, or the Internet**.

****I hereby grant _____** **I hereby do not grant_____**
permission to the Ocean Springs School District to place my child's name, individual student picture and/or creative work(s) **on a school- or district-related newsletter, or community newspaper.**

******** **Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

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OCEAN SPRINGS SCHOOL DISTRICT
ONLINE GREYHOUND HANDBOOK ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Student handbooks are located online at the Ocean Springs School District website: www.ossdms.org. There are unique handbooks for elementary, middle, and high school. Handbooks are prepared for the purpose of presenting information that will help students and parents to know the opportunities and responsibilities that will be a part of the school experience. Handbooks should be of interest to all students and their parents, and we hope that information supplied in it will be of material assistance. Student handbooks are designed . . .

- to acquaint students with the organization of the Ocean Springs Schools;
- to prevent loss of time and to reduce confusion to a minimum in getting the school organized for this year's work;
- to put in writing the policies and procedures which the administration and faculty have set up as guides for the students; and
- to systemize the school work for students.

Students and parents are encouraged to read, discuss, and develop a thorough understanding of the discipline guidelines presented in the *Greyhound Handbooks*.

Please note: The Ocean Springs student handbooks do not constitute a contract between the school district and its students. The plans, policies and procedures described in the student handbooks are subject to change by the Board of Trustees and/or school administration at any time. Failure to read the student handbook and other sources of regulations governing the Ocean Springs School District does not excuse the student from the requirements and regulations described therein.

The policies of the Ocean Springs School District are published in their entirety at www.ossdms.org.

Please acknowledge the plans, policies, and procedures of the Ocean Springs School District as outlined in the student handbook at www.ossdms.org by clicking-

- I acknowledge the plans, policies, and procedures of the Ocean Springs School District as outlined in the student handbook at www.ossdms.org

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OCEAN SPRINGS SCHOOL DISTRICT
Summary Of The Mississippi School Safety Act Of 2001
Online Agreement

Recently, state legislators enacted the Mississippi School Safety Act of 2001. The School Safety Act of 2001 is cumulative and in addition to the school district's existing authority regarding discipline of students. The Act recognizes the teacher as the authority in classroom matters regarding the school district's code of conduct.

Pursuant to the Mississippi School Safety Act of 2001, a teacher may remove a student who, in the professional judgment of the teacher, is disrupting the learning environment. ***If the removal is approved by the principal or assistant principal, the student may not be returned to the classroom until a conference has been held with the student's parent, guardian or custodian.*** During the conference, the disruptive behavior will be discussed and an agreement will be reached that no further disruption will be tolerated. The conference may be in person, by telephone, by e-mail or by other written communication.

Among other provisions, this act provides that a student 13 years of age or older may be subject to automatic expulsion on the third occurrence of habitually disruptive behavior during a school year. (Students under age 13 may be subject to expulsion for such conduct pursuant to other school policies and procedures.) For children under the age of 13, the district is now authorized to have a psychological evaluation performed on the child following a second act of disruptive behavior.

The term ***"disruptive behavior"*** means conduct of a student that is so unruly, disruptive or abusive that it seriously interferes with a teacher's or administrator's ability to communicate with the students in a classroom, with a student's ability to learn, or with the operation of a school or school-related activity, and which is not covered by other laws related to violence or possession of weapons or controlled substances on school property, school vehicles or at school-related activities. The law defines such behaviors to include, but not limited to: foul, profane, obscene, threatening, defiant or abusive language or action toward teachers or other school employees; defiance, ridicule or verbal attack of a teacher; and willful, deliberate and overt acts of disobedience of the directions of a teacher.

The term ***"habitually disruptive"*** in the law refers to actions by a student which cause disruption in a classroom, on school property or vehicles, or at a school-related activity on more than two occasions during a school year, and to disruptive behavior that was initiated, willful and overt on the part of the student and which required the attention of school personnel to deal with the disruption. After the third instance of such behavior, the child may be expelled.

After the second instance of behavior that is determined by the principal or designated administrator to have seriously interfered with the school environment, the parents/guardians will be contacted to help develop a behavior modification plan for the student. The Mississippi School Safety Act of 2001 authorizes the district to use audio/visual monitoring equipment in classrooms, hallways, buildings, grounds and buses for the purpose of monitoring disciplinary problems. Requirements imposed by federal law such as IDEA, Section 504, or the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA) supersede any state statutory provisions.

Please indicate that you have read the Summary of the Mississippi School Safety Act by clicking I have read the School Safety Act

*******Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

Age Appropriate Sex Education Curriculum Online Agreement

In accordance with House Bill 999, each school district in Mississippi must adopt a state approved Sex Education Curriculum. The Ocean Springs School District has adopted the "Choosing the Best" Curriculum (http://www.choosingthebest.org). Following the guidelines outlined in this bill, parents have the right to exclude their child from this instruction. This curriculum has been peer reviewed and approved by the Ocean Springs School Board, as well as the Mississippi Department of Education.

Your child's Science/Health teacher will begin teaching this curriculum this school year. There will be a total of 6 lessons that will be taught during the last 4 weeks of school. Instruction will be age appropriate. In grades 6-8 male and female students will be separated during instruction. Please feel free to visit the above website to review the curriculum and feel free to contact your child's Science teacher if you have additional questions.

Please indicate whether or not your child may participate in the lessons for the Sex Education Curriculum by clicking yes or no.

*******Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

Video Permission Online Agreement

At Ocean Springs School District there are certain videos shown for educational purposes. Although the films do have educational value and fit in with our curriculum, some may be rated PG/PG-13.

Please indicate if you DO or DO NOT want to allow your child to view educational movies that are PG/PG-13.

******Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

Home Internet Access

The Common Core Standards are calling upon students to think more and create more. A number of forces are conspiring to open up the classroom, integrate schooling with the larger world, and personalize education to students' individual needs, abilities, and interests. Digital technology is blending face-to-face instruction with personalized online learning that a textbook alone cannot give.

Although most OSSD courses are outfitted with a designated textbook, many of our teachers guide student learning with electronic resources. OSSD is sensitive to the fact that all students do not have internet access at home and that it is necessary to accommodate all students. Therefore, please indicate by clicking Yes or No whether or not your student has access to the internet at home so that teachers may provide alternate resources if necessary.

****Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

Ocean Springs School District
Alternative Travel Release Online Agreement

By clicking "I hereby grant permission for my student to travel to and from any MHSAA affiliated event associated with OSSD using district, charter, and/or private transportation and will accept full responsibility for medical, hospital and/or any other related expenses and do hereby hold harmless the Ocean Springs School District, the Board of Education of the Ocean Springs School District, their agents and/or assigns of all responsibilities for injuries or expenses and waive any and all claims which may arise against them as a result of participation in these events, including travel" , **you are submitting your signature electronically through the OSSD Parent Portal.**

By granting this permission you are agreeing for your student to travel to and from any MHSAA affiliated event associated with OSSD using district, charter, and/or private transportation. Also you are agreeing that you understand that your student may be transporting themselves or may be transported by another student or parent to and from activities associated with the athletic program and specifically granting permission to travel accordingly.

You are also agreeing that you will accept full responsibility for medical, hospital and/or any other related expenses and do hereby hold harmless the Ocean Springs School District, the Board of Education of the Ocean Springs School District, their agents and/or assigns of all responsibilities for injuries or expenses and waive any and all claims which may arise against them as a result of your student's participation in these events, including travel.

*******Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

Release of Student Information

The Buckley Amendment Regulations of 1980, called the Privacy Rights of Parents and Students, formerly known as the Family Education Rights and Privacy Act (FERPA), 34 Code of Federal Regulations Part 99, permits school officials under certain conditions to disclose certain *directory information* about enrolled students. School officials have the right to release *directory information* unless the parent or eligible student informs the principal that any or all of the information designated below should not be released without prior consent. Ocean Springs High School, however, has determined that student directory information will only be issued to universities, colleges, and branches of the United States military.

- the student's name, address, telephone listing, and date and place of birth;
- parent or lawful custodian's name, address, and telephone listing;
- major field of study and grade level classification, (Example: "high school student," or "10th grade," or "senior;")
- student's participation in officially recognized activities or sports (Example: "soccer team," or "Beta Club;")
- weight and height of members of athletic teams;
- dates of attendance, dates of enrollment, withdrawal, re-entry;
- diplomas, certificates, awards and honors received;
- most recent previous educational agency or institution attended by the student (Example: "transferred from Houston, Texas, high school")

Please click Yes or No to indicate whether or not you have objections to the release of *directory information about your student* being included in press releases, military recruiter lists, directories, official school rosters, honor roll lists, Awards Day Programs, school publications.

*******Note- By submitting your response through the OSSD Parent Portal you are submitting your signature electronically.**

OSSD Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy
Student Agreement/Parent Permission Form

I have read the Ocean Springs School District Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) Policy. I understand and will abide by the terms and conditions as stated.

- The district is not responsible for devices including loss; theft; maintenance; upkeep, or data loss and/or corruption.
- I understand that devices are only to be turned on when permitted by the teacher.
- I further understand that not following the guidelines set forth in this policy may result in a loss of privilege(s) as defined by the policy.

The Ocean Springs School District supports and respects each family's right to decide whether or not to allow your child to bring personal devices to school. All students will continue to be able to utilize school equipment as needed.

Please indicate YES if you DO Allow or NO if you DO NOT want to allow your child to bring personal devices to school.

Note**These permissions will be available for electronic signature by Parents/Gaurdians during registration.